

Blackwood If you have an agreed suit, you can find out how many Aces (and Kings) partner holds by using a 4NT bid. A reply of 5♣ shows 0 or 4, 5♦ shows 1, 5♥ shows 2 and 5♠ shows 3.

If your side has all four Aces, bidding 5NT will repeat the process for Kings.

The Replier can show one Ace plus a Void by bidding 6 of the Void suit if it ranks below the agreed trump, or 6 of the trump suit if the Void ranks above.

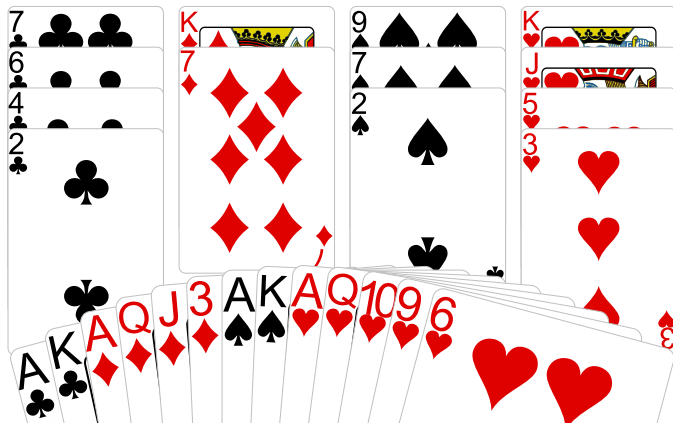
A Reply of 5NT shows two Aces plus a Void in some suit.

Gerber : Similar to Blackwood, this convention uses a 4♣ bid to initiate the Ace question, with 4♦ showing 0 or 4, 4♥ showing 1, 4♠ showing 2 and 4NT showing 3.

Not all 4♣ bids are Gerber, and deciding which ones are needs to be addressed by the partnership. For these Deals 4♣ is Gerber only when it follows a bid of 1NT or 2NT.

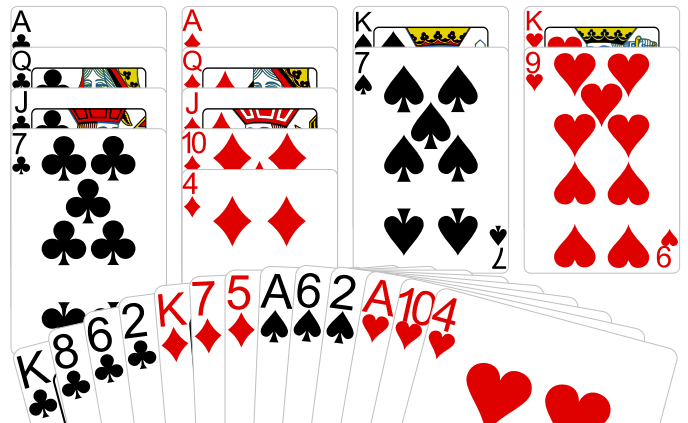
BakerBridge has complete lessons for these two conventions.

Deal 1 Ctr: 7NT Goal: at least ____ winners



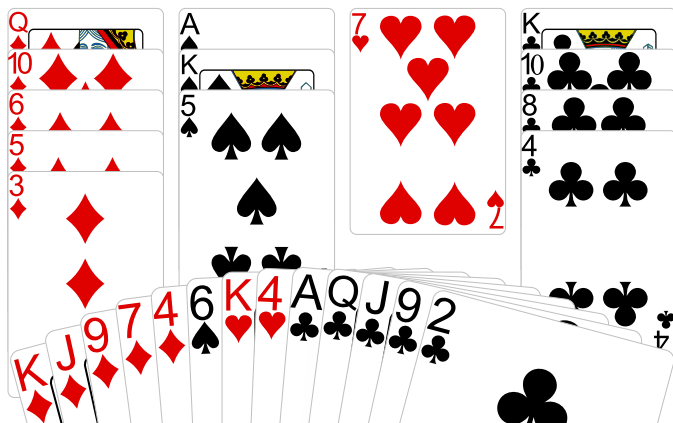
Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Deal 2 Ctr: 7NT Goal: at least ____ winners



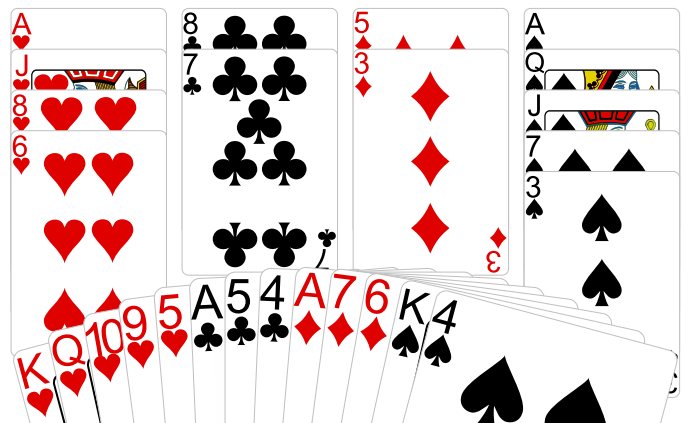
Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Deal 3 Ctr: 5♦ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 4 Ctr: 6♥ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 7NT

Declarer: North

Board: 2

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 7NT

Declarer: East

Board: 3

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 5 

Declarer: South

Board: 4

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 6 

Declarer: West

Deal 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 8 5
♥ 8 7 4
♦ T 8 6
♣ J T 5 3

27
2 4
7

♠ A K
♥ A Q T 9 6
♦ A Q J 3
♣ A K



♠ 9 7 2
♥ K J 5 3
♦ K 7
♣ 7 6 4 2

♠ Q T 6 4 3
♥ 2
♦ 9 5 4 2
♣ Q 9 8

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West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♥	Pass	3♥
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♣
Pass	5NT	Pass	6♥
Pass	7NT	Pass	

7NT by North

Deal 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 7
 ♥ K 9
 ♦ A Q J T 4
 ♣ A Q J 7

3
 20 14
 3

♠ Q J 8
 ♥ 3 2
 ♦ 9 8 6 3 2
 ♣ T 5 3



♠ T 9 5 4 3
 ♥ Q J 8 7 6 5
 ♦ -
 ♣ 9 4

♠ A 6 2
 ♥ A T 4
 ♦ K 7 5
 ♣ K 8 6 2

West	North	East	South
1 ♦	Pass	2NT	Pass
4 ♣	Pass	4 ♠	Pass
5 ♣	Pass	5 ♠	Pass
7NT			
All Pass			
7NT by East			

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WEST is just shy of a 2♣ opening bid, and when EAST shows 13-15 points WEST

wants to be in a slam.

WEST cannot use Blackwood because 4NT would be a natural invitation, but with EAST's latest bid

being 2NT he can use Gerber.

Two Major Aces and two Minor Kings fill the holes in WEST's hand so he bids 7NT.

Deal 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q J 8 4 3 2

♥ A 9 6 5 2

♦ 2

♣ 6

12
7 7
14

♠ A K 5

♥ 7

♦ Q T 6 5 3

♣ K T 8 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 6

♥ K 4

♦ K J 9 7 4

♣ A Q J 9 2

♠ T 9 7

♥ Q J T 8 3

♦ A 8

♣ 7 5 3

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SOUTH thinks slam may be possible, so she uses Blackwood.

And that's what Blackwood is really good for - keeping you out of slams when you are

missing two Aces!

West	North	East	South
			1 ♦
Pass	3 ♦	Pass	4 ♣
Pass	4 ♠	Pass	4NT
Pass	5 ♦		
All Pass			
5 ♦ by South			

Deal 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ K 4
 ♥ K Q T 9 5
 ♦ A 7 6
 ♣ A 5 4

4
 16 12
 8

♠ T 5
 ♥ 7 3
 ♦ 9 8 4 2
 ♣ K J T 9 2



♠ 9 8 6 2
 ♥ 4 2
 ♦ K Q J T
 ♣ Q 6 3

♠ A Q J 7 3
 ♥ A J 8 6
 ♦ 5 3
 ♣ 8 7

West	North	East	South
		1 ♠	Pass
2 ♥	Pass	3 ♥	Pass
4NT	Pass	5 ♥	Pass
6 ♥			
All Pass			
6 ♥ by West			

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WEST knows EAST has at least five ♠s, and they might provide discards for two or three

of her minor suit losers.

She tries Blackwood and, sure enough, EAST comes through with two Aces.

Even with all the Aces WEST knows there are not enough points for Grand,

so she bids 6



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